REBUILT • HARDER • SMARTER

4-DAY WORKOUT PLAN

INTENSE EDITION

A more demanding 6-week lifting block: hard training with real recovery built in.

04	06	01-02	03
LIFT DAYS	WEEK BLOCK	REPS LEFT	RECOVERY DAYS

YOUR WEEK

MON	**CHEST + TRICEPS**	Heavy push + accessories
TUE	**BACK + BICEPS**	Pull volume; no heavy deadlift
WED	**LEGS + CORE**	Strength + controlled volume
THU	**SHOULDERS + ARMS**	Upper-body top-ups + bike intervals
FRI	**ACTIVE RECOVERY**	Easy 30-45 min walk
SAT	**RECOVERY**	Easy walk, mobility, hydrate
SUN	**REST DAY**	Full rest; optional easy walk

Before you start: this is general guidance, not medical advice. If you are new to lifting, returning from injury, or have a health condition, check with a doctor or qualified coach first. Stop any exercise that causes sharp pain.

MONDAY / PUSH FOCUS

Chest + Triceps

Heavy pressing first, then higher-rep work. More effective than adding sets to failure.

PREP / 8-12 MIN

5 min easy incline walk + shoulder mobility + 2-3 lighter bench warm-up sets.

MAIN SESSION

19 work sets • ~80-95 min total

#	EXERCISE	WORK SETS	REST	RIR	FORM / PURPOSE
1	 **Barbell bench press**	**4 × 5-8**	2-3m	2	Set shoulders; feet planted. No bouncing.
2	 **Incline dumbbell press**	**3 × 8-10**	2m	1-2	30-degree bench; controlled lowering.
3	 **Machine chest press**	**2 × 10-12**	90s	1-2	Steady range; stop before form breaks.
4	 **Cable chest fly**	**2 × 12-15**	60s	1	Slight elbow bend; smooth stretch.
5	 **Rope triceps pushdown**	**3 × 10-15**	75s	1-2	Keep elbows by your ribs.
6	 **Overhead cable extension**	**2 × 12-15**	60s	1-2	Elbows stable; choose pain-free range.
7	 **Dumbbell lateral raise**	**3 × 12-20**	60s	1-2	Lead with elbows, no body swing.

SMART INTENSITY

Pair cable fly + rope pushdown as a controlled superset (2 rounds). Optional from week 4: one drop set on the FINAL lateral-raise set only.

CORE: Dead bug 2 × 10/side + front plank 2 × 35-45 sec.

FINISH / Incline treadmill 12-15 min at an easy-moderate, talkable pace.

COACH NOTE: Keep 2 reps in reserve on bench; do not chase failure on heavy presses.

TUESDAY / PULL FOCUS

Back + Biceps

Strong pulling and upper-back work, without a heavy deadlift the day before squats.

PREP / 8-12 MIN

5 min easy rower + band pull-aparts + 2 light sets of your first back exercise.

MAIN SESSION

21 work sets • ~80-95 min total

#	EXERCISE	WORK SETS	REST	RIR	FORM / PURPOSE
1	 **Pull-up / assisted pull-up**	**4 × 6-10**	2m	1-2	Full controlled range; no kipping.
2	 **Chest-supported row**	**4 × 6-10**	2m	1-2	Pull elbows back without jerking.
3	 **Neutral-grip pulldown**	**3 × 10-12**	90s	1-2	Pull toward upper chest; stay tall.
4	 **Seated cable row**	**2 × 10-12**	75s	1	Reach then row; avoid rocking.
5	 **Reverse pec-deck fly**	**3 × 12-20**	60s	1-2	Rear shoulders; light and strict.
6	 **Cable curl / EZ-bar curl**	**3 × 8-12**	75s	1-2	Arms steady; pick a pain-free grip.
7	 **Rope hammer curl**	**2 × 12-15**	60s	1-2	Neutral wrist, controlled lowering.

SMART INTENSITY

Pair reverse pec-deck fly + rope hammer curls for 2 rounds to save time. Do not use momentum to make curls heavier.

CORE: Pallof press 2 × 12/side; exhale and resist rotation.

FINISH / Bike 10-12 min at a steady, moderate pace (not a race).

COACH NOTE: If your elbows or biceps tendons hurt, use a comfortable grip and reduce or skip loaded curls.

WEDNESDAY / LOWER BODY

Legs + Core

One focused hard leg day, with a sensible dose so you recover well for the rest of the week.

PREP / 8-12 MIN

5-7 min bike + leg swings + 2-4 gradual squat warm-up sets. Warm-up sets are not work sets.

MAIN SESSION

17 work sets • ~80-95 min total

#	EXERCISE	WORK SETS	REST	RIR	FORM / PURPOSE
1	 **Barbell back squat**	**3 × 5-8**	2-3m	2	Brace first; depth you can control.
2	 **Romanian deadlift**	**3 × 8-10**	2m	2	Hinge from hips; keep bar close.
3	 **Leg press**	**3 × 10-15**	90s	1-2	Full controllable range; no bounce.
4	 **Seated leg curl**	**3 × 10-15**	75s	1-2	Pause at peak; slow return.
5	 **Split squat / step-up**	**2 × 8/leg**	90s	2	Stable knee/foot alignment.
6	 **Standing calf raise**	**3 × 12-20**	60s	1-2	Full stretch and controlled top.

SMART INTENSITY

No failure sets for legs. Keep the lowering controlled, but do not deliberately chase soreness. First 1-2 weeks after a break: perform only 2 work sets of squats, RDLs and leg press.

CORE: Knee raises or reverse crunches 3 × 10-15.

FINISH / Easy spin 8-10 min. Avoid additional sprints, jumps or stair intervals.

COACH NOTE: If your legs are still sore by the weekend, lower Wednesday volume next week. Soreness is not a progress target.

THURSDAY / UPPER PUMP

Shoulders + Arms

Extra chest/back exposure and efficient arm supersets, then short, low-impact intervals.

PREP / 8-12 MIN

5 min easy bike + arm circles + 2 light overhead-press sets.

MAIN SESSION

22 work sets • ~85-100 min total

#	EXERCISE	WORK SETS	REST	RIR	FORM / PURPOSE
1	 **Overhead press**	**3 × 6-8**	2m	2	Brace core; stay within pain-free range.
2	 **Incline machine / DB press**	**2 × 10-12**	90s	1-2	Chest top-up; do not grind reps.
3	 **Neutral-grip cable row**	**2 × 10-12**	90s	1-2	Back top-up; chest stays tall.
4	 **Dumbbell lateral raise**	**3 × 12-20**	60s	1-2	Strict, smooth movement.
5	 **Face pull**	**2 × 15-20**	60s	1-2	Pull toward face; elbows high.
6	 **Cable EZ-bar curl**	**3 × 10-12**	75s	1-2	Shoulders quiet; full control.
7	 **Rope triceps pressdown**	**3 × 10-12**	75s	1-2	Lock shoulders; extend elbows.
8	 **Hammer curl**	**2 × 12-15**	60s	1	Comfortable grip; slow negative.
9	 **Overhead rope extension**	**2 × 12-15**	60s	1	Do not push through elbow pain.

SMART INTENSITY

After overhead work, alternate cable curls + rope pressdowns for 3 rounds. Then pair hammer curls + overhead extensions for 2 rounds. Rest 60-75 sec after each pairing.

CORE: Cable crunch 2 × 12-15; controlled reps.

FINISH / Bike: 3 min easy, 6 rounds of 30 sec hard / 90 sec easy, 2 min easy (17 min).

COACH NOTE: Bike intervals should feel challenging, not all-out. Skip them when tired or recovery is poor.

PROGRAMMING / HOW TO PROGRESS

Train hard. Progress on purpose.

Do not confuse intensity with doing every set to failure.

THE EFFORT RULE

RIR = reps in reserve. RIR 2 means you could complete about 2 more clean reps. Use RIR 2 on big lifts, RIR 1-2 on accessories. Only push an optional final isolation set close to failure when your joints feel good.

THE 6-WEEK BUILD

01 **BASELINE**
Find good weights. Most sets end with 2-3 RIR. Reduce leg sets if rusty.

02 **ADD REPS**
Keep loads mostly stable. Aim for 1 more quality rep somewhere.

03 **ADD LOAD**
When every set reaches its upper rep target, add the smallest load.

04 **OVERLOAD**
Hold clean technique. Optional ONE isolation drop set on Monday.

05 **HARD WEEK**
Accessories 1-2 RIR, big lifts 2 RIR. Never miss a heavy rep.

06 **DELOAD**
Cut work sets ~40-50%; stay 3-4 RIR. Prepare for the next block.

EXAMPLE: DOUBLE PROGRESSION

If your incline press target is 3 × 8-10, keep the weight until you can do 10 / 10 / 10 with clean form at the target effort. Then increase the weight slightly and work back up from 8s.

Rest 2-3 min after big lifts, 60-90 sec after smaller movements. Log sets, reps, load and how hard they felt.

SUPPORT THE TRAINING

Lose fat. Keep strength.

Training is the stimulus. Food and recovery determine how much you can sustain.

01 MODERATE DEFICIT

Aim for a small calorie deficit (roughly 250-400 kcal/day) if fat loss is your goal. Belly fat cannot be spot-reduced. Track average body weight and waist, not daily fluctuations.

02 EAT ENOUGH PROTEIN

Target ~1.6-2.0 g protein per kg body weight daily. Include a protein source in each meal, plus fruit and vegetables.

03 HYDRATE + FUEL

Drink consistently. Add fluids and some carbohydrate before hard sessions. Replace fluid losses after sweaty sessions.

04 PROTECT YOUR SLEEP

Target 7-9 hours over each 24-hour period where possible. On short-sleep or long-workday days, reduce weights and skip intervals.

SUNDAY = FULL REST DAY

No training on Sunday. Keep Friday and Saturday easy too, so you start Monday fresh; an easy walk is fine if you feel like moving. If Wednesday leg training leaves you sore for days, reduce leg volume rather than pushing harder.

JOINTS AND LONG-LASTING PAIN

Muscle effort is expected; sharp or persistent joint or tendon pain is not. Swap painful exercises for a controlled, comfortable variation. Pain that keeps coming back deserves an assessment by a qualified clinician or physiotherapist before you push heavier.

ADJUSTMENT CHECK EACH WEEK

Progress: better reps or more weight with sound technique.
Fat loss: waist trend and average scale weight over 2-3 weeks.
Recovery: energy, elbow/shoulder comfort and leg soreness.
If recovery worsens: remove a finisher or 1-2 accessory sets before adding more.

PRINTABLE / 6-WEEK TRACKER

Record the work.

Write the real numbers down; progression works only when you can measure it.

WEEK	AVG WT	WAIST	GYM / 4	CARDIO / 4	ENERGY 1-5
01					
02					
03					
04					
05					
06					

KEY LIFTS / LOG YOUR BEST CLEAN SET EACH WEEK

LIFT	W1	W2	W3	W4	W5	W6
Bench press						
Pull-up / pulldown						
Back squat						
Overhead press						
Waist / body weight						

MINIMUM EFFECTIVE RULE

On a busy week: complete the main 3-4 lifts, skip the optional finisher, and keep technique strong. Consistency over months beats a single exhausting session.

PICTURE GUIDE / LARGER VIEW

Know your machines

The same pictures used beside each exercise, drawn bigger. Teal = pads and handles you touch.



Barbell bench press



Incline dumbbell press



Machine chest press



Cable chest fly



Rope triceps pushdown



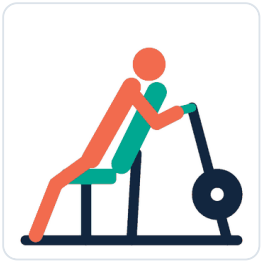
Overhead cable extension



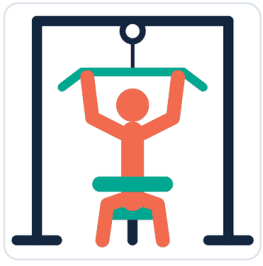
Dumbbell lateral raise



Pull-up / assisted pull-up



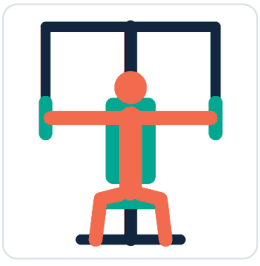
Chest-supported row



Neutral-grip pulldown



Seated cable row



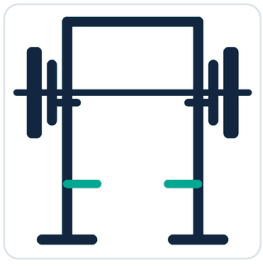
Reverse pec-deck fly



Cable curl / EZ-bar curl



Rope hammer curl



Barbell back squat



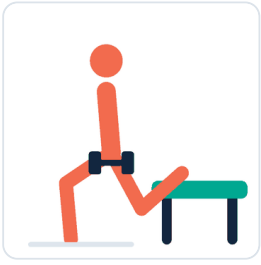
Romanian deadlift



Leg press



Seated leg curl



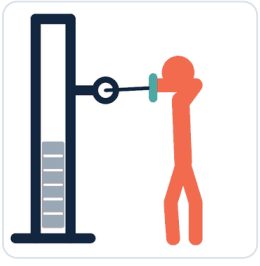
Split squat / step-up



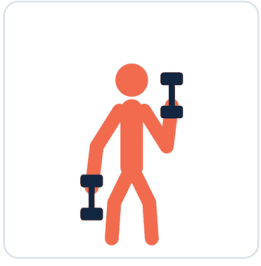
Standing calf raise



Overhead press



Face pull



Hammer curl